

# SHEEP



Sheep are raised for their meat, for the foods that can be made from their milk, and for their wool. There are more than 200 breeds of sheep and different sorts are able to live in very different places—in lands that are hot with little water, in areas that are cold and wet, in the lowlands, and on the hills.

The kind of place where it lives affects the quality of the sheep's meat and wool.

## Sheep produce

Sheep provide yogurt and cheese, and wool for clothing. The wool contains a fat called lanolin. It is used in ointments and hand creams.

Lanolin



Yogurt



Cheese



Milk



*It takes the wool from one average-sized fleece to make this sweater.*

## All in a day's work

An experienced shearer can shear a lot of sheep in one day. At shearing time, shearers travel from farm to farm to clip the animals.



*Hand-operated shears or electric clippers are used by the shearer.*

*Sheep are shorn in the spring and early summer when they no longer need their long coats to keep them warm.*

*The fleece is made into wool for knitting and for making carpets and fabrics. Sometimes, it is even used to fill mattresses.*